

MUST FOR EVERY STUDENT ... FOR ALL COMPETITIVE EXAMS

ENGLISH MADE SIMPLE!

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MODULE -29



Sledgehammer approach:

Used to describe a way of behaving that is too forceful.

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Sledgehammer is a heavy hammer with a long handle used for breaking stones or other heavy material.

Example :

If parents use **sledgehammer approach**, it stifles innovative and creative ideas in young children.

Guise : *The appearance of someone / something, especially when intended to deceive.*

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Example :
The company XXX has been selling the products under the **guise** of market research.

Guise : *The appearance of someone / something, especially when intended to deceive.*

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Example :

To break the stranglehold of drug mafia, the police officers quite often arrive in the **guise** of drug dealers.

Ruse : *A trick intended to deceive someone.*

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Example :

Wife wants to plan a surprise birthday party for her husband, and that's why she sent him out to the supermarket for an hour as a **ruse**, so that his closest friends can come to the house without him noticing.

Impediment : *Hindrance / obstruction to do something.*

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Example :
In several African countries,
ignorance is the main
impediment for progress.

Dubious : *Thought not to be completely true or not able to be trusted.*

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Example :
The claims of XXX company are **dubious** and not supported by scientific evidence.

Dubious : *Feeling doubt or not feeling certain.*

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**TATA
CONSULTANCY
SERVICES**

Example :
XXX joined TCS with
dubious documents.

Ambivalent : *Having two opposing feelings at the same time or being uncertain about how you feel.*

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Example :

To cure various diseases, his wife depends on homeopathy, and her husband has **ambivalent** attitude towards it.

Slugfest : *A situation in which people compete very hard with each other in order to be successful.*

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Example :
For XXX constituency, there are two aspirants to get the party ticket and the **slugfest** continues between these two probables.

Tenable : *Able to be defended successfully / reasonable / possible to achieve / possible to defend.*

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Example :
As the science progresses,
some of the scientific theories
will no longer be **tenable**.

Untenable : *Not able to be defended against criticism / no longer able to continue.*

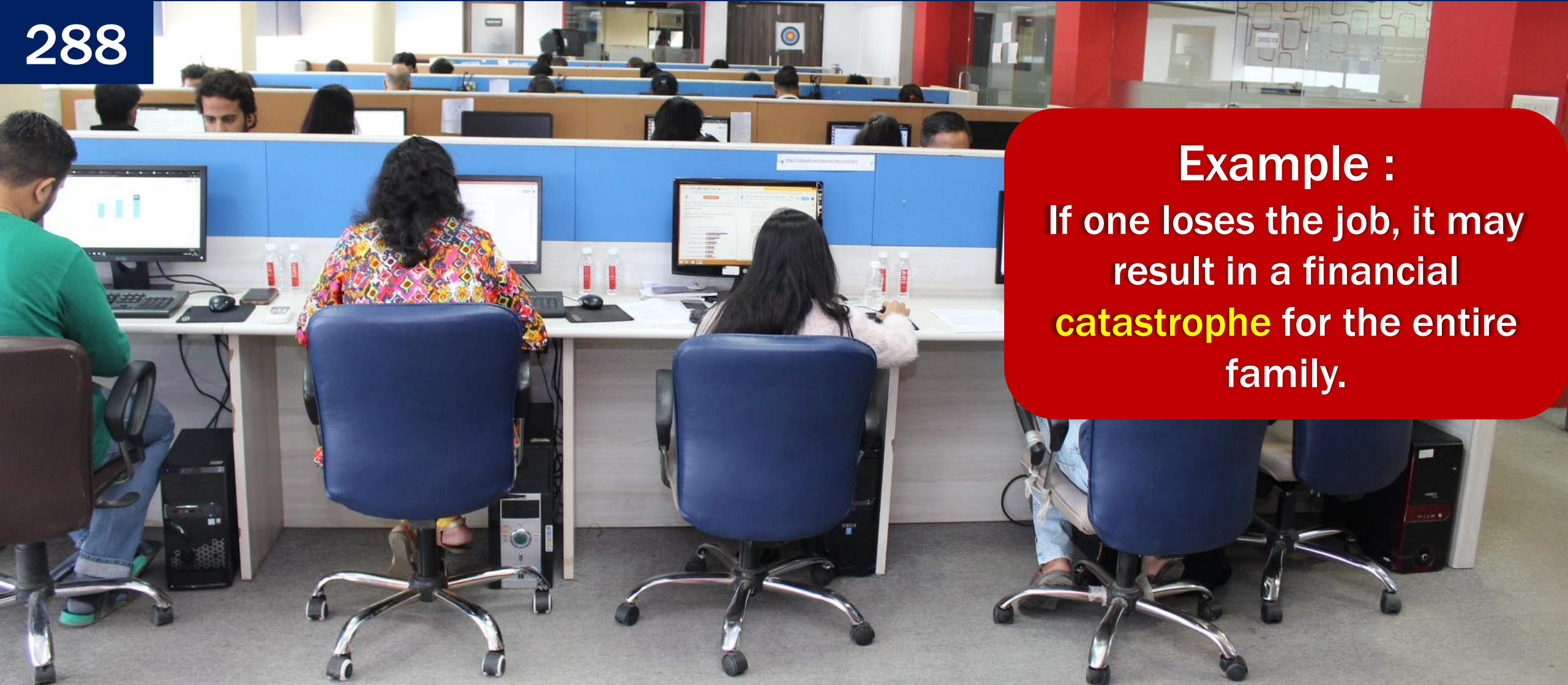
287



Example :
The arguments of the Labour Unions for increase in pay are totally **untenable**.

Catastrophe : *A sudden event that causes very great destruction / suffering / trouble.*

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Example :
If one loses the job, it may
result in a financial
catastrophe for the entire
family.

Catastrophe : *A sudden event that causes very great destruction / suffering / trouble.*

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Example :
Continued rain may result in **catastrophic** flooding and no city is an exception.

Cataclysmic : *Causing a lot of destruction or a sudden violent change.*

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Example :
Greenhouse gases could cause a **cataclysmic** change in the World's climate.



Cataclysmic : *Causing a lot of destruction or a sudden violent change.*

289



Example :
The consequences of bankruptcy of Banks / Financial Institutions are potentially **cataclysmic**.

Business Standard

03-11-2023

Engagement discontent

US lawsuits can change social-media functioning

In an unusual concerted move, 41 US states and the District of Columbia have filed lawsuits, accusing Meta of designing algorithms that harm children, and concealing internal research that provides evidence of such harm. The bipartisan group of attorneys general is also suing the social-media giant for restitution to the families they allege were harmed by platforms such as Facebook and Instagram, which are run by Meta. Over 60 per cent of American teenagers use Instagram. These cases are unprecedented because they apply the norms of consumer protection to companies typically viewed as technology-driven information services. Indeed, this sort of concerted bipartisan legal action has only occurred in the past in lawsuits that forced changes in the practices of the tobacco and pharma sectors. By analogy to those historical precedents, these could force massive transformations in the way social-media platforms and apps work.

The thrust of the lawsuits is that Meta chose to maximise its profits by deliberately ignoring evidence it had gathered, showing that minors were being harmed by the way social-media platforms worked. The allegation is that the company exploited and harmed children by designing algorithms that exploited the vulnerabilities of developing brains. As a result, young users often developed anxiety, despair, eating disorders, and insomnia. Moreover, the lawsuits allege that Meta published misleading data to show low rates of negative and harmful experiences by users. Meta's subsidiaries Facebook and Instagram require parental authorisation from users under the age of 13 in order to create an account. But a lawsuit by 33 states also claims that Meta obtained and monetised personal data from users under the legal age limit who haven't given the required consent. Another eight states have filed separate legal actions with similar allegations.

The lawsuit says that Meta used recommendation algorithms that exploited the ways in which dopamine production is triggered in young brains. Dopamine is the neurotransmitter hormone that delivers pleasure, and addictions are closely connected to the triggering of dopamine production. The suits allege Meta chose to exploit those vulnerabilities through targeted features such as dopamine-manipulating algorithms. They cite "likes" and social comparison features known by Meta to harm young users; audiovisual and haptic alerts that pull young users to social media even while at school and during the night; visual filter features known to promote body dysmorphia; and content-presentation formats, like infinite scroll, and ephemeral content designed to prevent attempts to disengage with social media.

Some of this evidence comes courtesy of a whistle-blower Frances Haugen, who testified before the US Congress in 2021, citing internal studies from Meta. The US surgeon general has issued a statement that social media is a driver of a "national youth mental health crisis". Many experts from fields like neurology are also cited in the suits and the medical evidence of linkage to addiction could ultimately be crucial. Social media's business model is based upon engagement and its monetisation. The more hours users spend on platforms, the higher the ad revenue that can be generated, and the more the monetisable insights that can be derived from data analysis. If the courts decide that engagement leads to addiction and has other harmful impacts, especially on teenagers and children, the entire industry will have to review its practices.

ENGAGEMENT DISCONTENT

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In an unusual **concerted** move, 41 US states and the District of Columbia have filed lawsuits, **accusing** Meta of designing **algorithms** that harm children, and **concealing** internal research that provides **evidence** of such harm. The **bipartisan** group of attorneys general is also **suing** the social media giant for **restitution** to the families they allege **were harmed** by platforms such as Facebook and Instagram, which are run by Meta. Over 60 per cent of American teenagers use Instagram. These cases are **unprecedented** because they apply the norms of consumer protection to companies **typically** viewed as technology driven information services. **Indeed**, this sort of concerted bipartisan legal action has only occurred in the past in lawsuits that forced changes in the practices of the tobacco and pharma sectors. By **analogy** to those historical **precedents**, these **could force** massive **transformations** in the way social media platforms and apps work. The **thrust** of the lawsuits is that Meta chose to maximise its profits by **deliberately** ignoring evidence it **had gathered**, showing that minors were being harmed by the way social media platforms worked.

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